

Lead playbook

Who we hunt, when we strike, what we say, and the weekly numbers that prove it's working. The messages themselves live in the outreach kit — this is the system that decides where they land.

1 • THE HUNTING LIST

We sell to main contractors who buy interior packages, and to nobody else — no developers, no end clients, no residential one-offs. Below is the starting list by market. Confirm it, strike out anyone who fails the qualification test in section 3, and grow it to a hundred names. It lives in one shared sheet with three columns beside each firm: the person, the last touch, the next touch.

MARKET	START WITH
UAE	ALEC, Khansaheb, ASGC, Multiplex Middle East, BESIX / Six Construct, Dutco, Shapoorji Pallonji, Al Naboodah — plus every main contractor named on hoardings between the airport and the office.
Ireland	John Sisk & Son, BAM Ireland, John Paul Construction, Walls, PJ Hegarty, Bennett, Collen, Flynn.
UK & NI	Gilbert-Ash, Graham, McLaughlin & Harvey, Farrans — the relationships we hold — then McAleer & Rushe, O'Hare & McGovern, Wates, Mace, Kier fit-out teams.
Australia	Multiplex, Built, Hutchinson Builders, Roberts Co, FDC, Richard Crookes.

Finding the person. The buyer is the commercial manager, procurement lead or managing QS — never info@. Two ways that work: search the firm on LinkedIn and filter people by "commercial" or "procurement" in our market; or simply ring the office and ask who looks after subcontractor enquiries for fit-out packages. Receptionists tell you. Log the name before sending anything.

2 • WHEN TO STRIKE — THE TRIGGERS

A cold email on a random Tuesday competes with everything. The same email the week a contractor wins a job is the answer to a problem they've just acquired. Watch for these, fifteen minutes every morning with the coffee:

- **Project awards.** A contractor announcing a new tower, hotel or office scheme is about to buy a drywall package. This is the highest-value trigger there is — reference the project by name in the first line.
- **Planning approvals and ground-breakings** in our sectors. Six to twelve months from an interiors tender; early enough to get on the list.
- **People moves.** A new commercial manager wants a better supply chain than the one they inherited. Congratulate, then introduce.
- **Our own clients winning work.** When Graham or Sisk announce a scheme, that's a warm call the same day, not an email.
- **Tender portals and frameworks** in each market — checked weekly, owned by one named person.

3 • THE QUALIFICATION TEST

Chasing everything is how a pipeline fills with noise. Before a name earns a first touch, it passes four questions — and after what happened to the supply chains of the big collapses, the last one is the one that saves the company:

1. **Do they buy packages our size?** Interior packages roughly AED 2m–25m or the local equivalent. Below that we're too dear; far above it, we're a risk to ourselves.
2. **Our sectors?** Residential, workplace, hotels and leisure, education. Anything else is a director's call, not a default yes.
3. **Our geography?** Within reach of markets where we can actually put supervision on the floor.
4. **Do they pay?** Ask two subcontractors who work for them; check filed accounts where public. Slow-and-certain beats fast-and-maybe. A contractor with a payment reputation problem goes on the walk-away list no matter how shiny the project — a bad lead converted is worse than no lead.

4 • THE FIFTEEN MINUTES

The emails earn a reply; this is what to do with it. The aim of the call is never a sale — it's one of two outcomes: a sit-down, or a live enquiry to price. Nothing else counts.

Open — twenty seconds, then stop talking

"Thanks for the time — I'll keep this short. We're a fit-out and drywall specialist, trading since 1986, and the one thing different about us is we self-deliver the whole interior package with our own people. I'm not asking you to change anything today — I want to understand how you buy your interior packages and whether we're worth a place on the list. **What's coming up for you in the next six months?**"

Then three questions, in order

- "How do packages usually get split on your jobs — one interiors contractor or several trades?" (Their answer sets up the interface pitch.)
- "What's gone wrong for you with drywall subcontractors before?" (They'll tell you exactly what to promise.)
- "What does a new subcontractor have to show you before you'll tender them?" (This is them reading you their buying process. Write it down.)

The offer

"Easiest way to judge us costs you nothing: send over one live package — drawings and programme — and you'll have an honest price the same working day, with every figure traceable to a line on the drawing. If the number's wrong, you've lost nothing. If it's right, you've found a second string."

The three replies you'll hear

- **"We've got our supply chain."** — "Every good contractor has. I'm asking to be the firm you ring when the usual one's stretched — and on the evidence side, every wall we build is photographed before it closes and handed over as a record. When that matters on a job, we're the call."
- **"Send your details."** — "They're already in your inbox. What I'd rather send is a price on something real — what's the next package going out?"
- **"You'll just be a price check."** — "Then check us. We win our share of honest comparisons, and we'd rather be checked than unknown."

End every call with a date: the sit-down, the tender issue date, or the next call. A conversation without a date attached is a lead going cold politely.

5 • THE WEEK, IN NUMBERS

The rhythm is modest and relentless, and the numbers go to the CEO every Monday — not because anyone's checking up, but because a pipeline that isn't counted quietly stops existing.

EVERY WEEK	TARGET
New first touches (qualified names only)	10
Follow-ups sent on the day they fall due	All of them
Trigger-based touches (award, move, approval)	3 of the 10
Real conversations held	2
Appointments or live enquiries won	1

Every touch, reply and date lives in the shared sheet — or in EDM OS once the pilot lands, where this whole playbook becomes the pipeline board. And one leak gets plugged before the first email goes out: **the website form key**, set up under a company account, ten minutes, so the enquiry that arrives at 11pm reaches an inbox instead of vanishing. Leads are too dear to lose to a form.

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